

Dear Hiring Manager, Search Committee, Selection Committee, or Community Partner,

I am writing to introduce myself as a multidisciplinary professional whose experience sits at the intersection of electrical engineering, project coordination, community leadership, digital strategy, mentoring, cultural work, and organizational development. My formal career is rooted in electrical engineering and building systems design, but my full body of work extends far beyond drawings, panels, load calculations, and construction documents. I am an engineer, an EIT, a project coordinator, a creative strategist, a fraternity leader, a church servant, a mentor, a writer, and a builder of systems that help people and organizations become stronger.

I earned my Bachelor of Science in Electrical Engineering from the Rochester Institute of Technology, later strengthened my business foundation with an Associate of Science in Business Administration from Hudson Valley Community College, and added construction management education through San Joaquin Community College. Across my career, I have worked in electrical engineering, consulting engineering, building systems design, project coordination, fire alarm and life safety environments, construction-related coordination, and public-sector design support. I currently serve as a Project Engineer II / Electrical Engineer at Stratus, formerly Ascent Engineering Group, where I support educational, institutional, public-sector, and community-centered projects involving power distribution, lighting, fire alarm coordination, low-voltage systems, utility coordination, design documentation, RFI responses, submittal review, construction administration, field observations, and owner communication.

What makes my background different is that I do not approach engineering as a narrow technical function. I see engineering as service, communication, risk management, stewardship, and public trust. On any given project, the math matters, but so does the explanation. The panel schedule matters, but so does the owner's ability to understand the impact. The RFI response matters, but so does protecting the design team, the client relationship, the construction schedule, and the integrity of the final building. My strongest professional value often comes from translating complexity into clarity.

My work has included school renovations, public-sector facilities, service coordination, PV and metering discussions, electrical load analysis, low-voltage coordination, fire alarm and access control coordination, electrical demolition and new-work planning, existing-condition review, meeting notes, field reports, punch list support, and project documentation. I have learned how to work with architects, owners, contractors, mechanical engineers, plumbing engineers, civil engineers, structural engineers, technology consultants, utility representatives, and internal project managers. I understand the pressure of real projects, where information is incomplete, decisions are time-sensitive, and communication can either solve a problem or create a bigger one.

Outside of formal employment, I founded Lomnick Professional Services, also known as LomnickPro, as a creative and strategic platform for organizations and individuals who need help presenting themselves with clarity and professionalism. Through LomnickPro, I have supported websites, graphic design, flyers, business cards, presentation decks, branding, resumes, professional bios, social media materials, community campaigns, church visuals, fraternity communications, and nonprofit storytelling. I created LomnickPro because I saw too many good people and good organizations doing meaningful work with public-facing materials that did not reflect their true impact. My role became helping them look as strong, organized, and credible as they actually are.

That same instinct drives my leadership in Iota Phi Theta Fraternity, Incorporated. I was initiated on July 9, 2011, through Pi Omega Chapter in New York City, and I now serve as a major leader within Omicron Omega Chapter in Richmond, Virginia. My roles have included Vice Polaris, chapter webmaster, branding strategist, advisor, intake leader, professional development supporter, and NPHC-MR webmaster. I have

helped modernize chapter websites, improve social media presence, create recruitment materials, support intake processes, mentor younger brothers, preserve chapter history, and strengthen our public presence across Richmond. I lead with the fraternity's five principles in view: Scholarship, Leadership, Citizenship, Fidelity, and Brotherhood. Those are not just words to me. They are standards for how I work, how I mentor, how I build systems, and how I protect organizational reputation.

My Iota work has also taught me the importance of succession. A leader who has to do everything himself has not built a system; he has built dependency. In chapter work, church work, engineering work, and mentoring work, I believe in training the next person, documenting the process, creating templates, identifying backups, and making sure the mission does not collapse if one person is unavailable. That operating philosophy has shaped my approach to chapter leadership, intake compliance, mentoring, meeting documentation, event planning, website systems, and professional development.

My church life has been equally important to my development. At Third Street Bethel AME Church in Richmond, I have served through the Media Ministry, Trustee Board, Internal Audit Committee, and Young Men's Mentoring Program. I have helped support worship technology, livestream graphics, digital communication, church events, media guides, trustee presentations, audit-minded documentation, and youth mentoring. Church media taught me that technology is not just equipment; it is access. A clean livestream, a working microphone, a clear bulletin, or a well-designed presentation can help people receive the message, trust the institution, and stay connected to the community.

Through the Young Men's Mentoring Program, I have worked with young men on leadership, confidence, emotional intelligence, faith, professional exposure, academic growth, accountability, and life skills. My mentoring style is direct, practical, and human. I believe young people need encouragement, but they also need standards. They need someone who can help them tie a tie, write a resume, think through conflict, own their mistakes, and see a future beyond whatever pressure they are facing in the moment.

My leadership foundation began earlier at the Rochester Institute of Technology through the National Society of Black Engineers. As a student, I served in NSBE roles including Academic Excellence Chair, Programs Chair, and Vice President. NSBE gave me a platform to lead, support Black engineering students, build academic culture, organize programs, and expose younger students to STEM. That experience still influences my work today. When I help a young man update a resume, encourage a brother to pursue certification, support a student interested in engineering, or explain a technical concept in plain language, I am still carrying the NSBE mission forward.

I also bring a strong creative and cultural background. I am the author of *Lionheart: The Joel Lomnick Story*, a memoir project that explores family, faith, engineering, grief, identity, leadership, community, Iota Phi Theta, the AME Church, NSBE, African drum and dance, mentoring, and personal reinvention. Writing has sharpened my ability to tell the truth, organize complicated life experiences, and communicate with emotional clarity. It has also made me a stronger professional communicator because I understand that facts alone are not always enough. People need structure, context, and meaning.

Cultural arts have also shaped my leadership. I have participated in West African drum and dance across Rochester, Albany, Troy, and Richmond through communities and groups including Bush Mango Drum & Dance Ensemble, Bata con Pies, EBA Dance Theatre, Ezibu Muntu African Dance Company, Akoma de Gado Drum & Dance Ensemble, and Break It Down RVA. These experiences taught me rhythm, discipline, community presence, cultural respect, performance, and the healing power of movement. Line dancing with Break It Down RVA and other Richmond instructors has also reinforced my belief that community does not always have to be built through formal meetings. Sometimes it is built through rhythm, joy, shared space, and showing up consistently.

My entrepreneurial interests also include real estate education and business development. Through real estate investor networking and related learning, I have studied wholesaling concepts, property research, Richmond and Rochester housing markets, investor communication, and the relationship between housing, wealth, construction, and community stability. I am also connected to Olunirun Enterprises LLC as part of my broader professional, creative, consulting, and entrepreneurial vision. Long-term, I see my work growing into a platform that combines engineering knowledge, creative services, real estate understanding, community development, and mentorship.

Across all of these experiences, the common thread is this: I build bridges between systems and people. I can sit in an engineering meeting and discuss electrical service impacts. I can sit with a church committee and explain media needs. I can help a fraternity chapter modernize its public image without disrespecting its elders. I can help a young man turn scattered experience into a resume. I can turn rough project notes into a clear scope narrative. I can take a messy idea and give it structure.

I am not a one-dimensional candidate. I am not only an engineer, only a designer, only a mentor, or only a community leader. My strength is the combination. I bring technical discipline, creative communication, cultural intelligence, lived resilience, practical leadership, and a deep commitment to helping others improve. I care about doing excellent work, but I also care about building people and systems that last.

I would welcome the opportunity to bring this full range of experience to a role, partnership, board, committee, project team, or leadership opportunity that values technical competence, strong communication, community impact, and ethical leadership. Whether the need is engineering coordination, project leadership, organizational strategy, digital modernization, youth development, community engagement, or mission-driven communication, I bring a builder's mindset and a servant-leader's heart.

Thank you for your time and consideration.

Sincerely,

Joel Maurice Lomnick, EIT